

Ἰουλιανὸς ὁ Ἀποστάτης

Julian the Apostate on Philosophy, Empire, and the Old Gods

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Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

Dialect: Ἀττικίζουσα [Atticizing](#)

Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)

Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Affiliation: [Neoplatonist](#)

Julian, known historically as Julian the Apostate, was a Roman Emperor and philosopher of the 4th century CE. Born in Constantinople in 331 or 332, he was a member of the imperial family. After a closely supervised youth, he received an education that secretly drew him toward traditional Greek philosophy and religion, despite his Christian upbringing. He studied Neoplatonism in cities such as Ephesus and Athens.

In 355, he was appointed a junior emperor, or Caesar, and sent to Gaul, where he proved to be a successful military commander. His troops later proclaimed him senior emperor, or Augustus, in 360, and he ruled as sole emperor from 361 until his death in 363 during a campaign against Persia. As emperor, Julian publicly rejected Christianity, which earned him the label "Apostate," and attempted to restore traditional Roman religious practices. He promoted a philosophically refined form of paganism centered on the sun god Helios. His reign represents the last major effort to reverse the Christianization of the Roman Empire.

Julian was also a prolific author who wrote in a classicizing Greek style. His surviving works include philosophical orations like the Hymn to King Helios, numerous letters, and satires such as The Caesars and Misopogon, or The Beard-Hater. He also wrote a treatise titled Against the Galilaeans, which is preserved mostly in fragments through quotations by Christian critics. These writings provide crucial insight into the religious and intellectual conflicts of his time, as well as the ideals of a Neoplatonic philosopher-king. Although his religious revival failed, his works remained important for later pagan and Christian thinkers.

Works (20)

- Κατὰ Γαλιλαίων · [Against the Galileans](#) · 71 passages
- Μισοπῶγων · [Beard-Hater](#) · 44 passages
- Ἐπὶ τῇ ἐξόδῳ τοῦ ἀγαθωτάτου Σαλουστίου · [Consolatithe Departure of Most Noble Salustius](#) · 10 passages
- Ἐπιστολαὶ Ἀμφίβολοι · [Dubious Letters](#) · 6 passages
- Ἐγκώμιον εἰς τὸν αὐτοκράτορα Κωνστάντιον · [encom to Emperor Constantius](#) · 43 passages
- Εὐσεβίας τῆς βασιλίδος ἐγκώμιον · [encom to Empress Eusebia](#) · 24 passages
- Ἐπιγράμματα · [Epigrams](#) · 3 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀντιοχείας · [Fragments on Antioch](#) · 1 passages
- Ἐπιστολαὶ περὶ Βιθυνικῆς Κτήσεως · [Letters on a Bithynian Estate](#) · 88 passages
- Πρὸς Ἡράκλειον κυνικὸν περὶ τοῦ πῶς κυνιστέον · [On Cynicism](#) · 29 passages
- Περὶ τῶν τοῦ αὐτοκράτορος πράξεων ἢ περὶ βασιλείας · [On the Emperor's Deeds or-Kingship](#) · 44 passages

- Ἐπιγράμματα καὶ Ἀποσπάσματα · Short Poems and Fragments · 21 passages
- Ἐπιστολαὶ Νόθαι · Spurious Letters · 5 passages
- Συμπόσιον ἢ Κρόνια · Symposium or Kronia · 2 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · Testimonies · 3 passages
- Εἰς τὸν βασιλέα Ἥλιον πρὸς Σαλούστιον · To King Helios, To Salustius · 42 passages
- Ἀθηναίων τῇ βουλῇ καὶ τῷ δήμῳ · To the Council and People of Athens · 16 passages
- Εἰς τὴν μητέρα τῶν θεῶν · To the Mother of the Gods · 22 passages
- Εἰς τοὺς ἀπαιδεύτους κύνας · To the Uneducated Dogs · 21 passages
- Θεμιστίῳ φιλοσόφῳ · To Themistius the Philosopher · 14 passages

Other Neoplatonist Authors

- Ἀμελίου Ἐπιστολὴ · Amelius Letters · 1 work
- Ἀμμώνιος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Ammonius of Alexandria Phil · 5 works
- Δαμάσκιος ὁ Δαμασκηνός · Damascius of Damascus · 7 works
- Δαβίδ ὁ Ἀνίκητος · David the Invincible · 2 works
- Δέξιππος ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Dexippus the Neoplatonist · 1 work
- Ἠλίας ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Elias the Neoplatonist · 3 works
- Εὐσέβιος ὁ Μύνδιος · Eusebius of Myndus · 1 work
- Ἱεροκλῆς ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Hierocles of Alexandria · 1 work
- Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Ἀνώνυμος · Iamblichus Anonymous · 1 work
- Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis · 6 works
- Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis II · 1 work
- Μαρῖνος ὁ Νεαπολίτης · Marinus of Neapolis · 1 work